

Document Description

Sr. No	Document Details	
1.	Title	HR Manual
2.	Description	Outlines the policies, programs, and benefits available to eligible employees
3.	Version	5.0
4.	Author	Minal Bahirat
5.	Classification	Confidential
6.	Review Date	01 April 2026
7.	Reviewer & Custodian	Seema Yadav
8.	Approved By	Rajnesh Kumar
9.	Release Date	01 April 2026
10.	Owner	Seema Yadav

Distribution List

All employees

Document Control Log

Version	Change Description	Date
5.0	-Amendments in Separation Process	02 April 2026
4.0	-Clause updation in Advance Salary	14 November 2025
3.0	- Clause updation in Code of Conduct and Business Ethics - Amendment in CL application criteria	18 April 2024
2.0	- Additions done: - Inclusive work environment - Non-Discrimination - Diversity in recruitment and - promotion processes - Child and forced labour - Modern slavery - Data Privacy	27 October 2023
1.0	- HR Manual policy document created	14 September 2020

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INTRODUCTION

This Employee HR Manual has been developed to describe some of the expectations from our employees and to outline the policies, programs, and benefits available to eligible employees. Employees should familiarize themselves with the contents of the HR Manual as soon as possible, for it will answer many questions about employment with Aligned Automation.

Purpose of the HR Manual

This HR Manual is designed to acquaint you with Aligned Automation and provide you with information about working conditions, employee benefits, and some of the policies affecting your employment. The content in this document is confidential in nature and nothing contained herein shall be published or shared outside the company for any reason whatsoever. This HR Manual is not a contract and is not intended to create any contractual or legal obligations. You should read, understand, and comply with all provisions of the HR Manual. It describes many of your responsibilities as an employee and outlines the programs developed by Aligned Automation to benefit employees.

No HR Manual can anticipate every circumstance or question about policy. As Aligned Automation continues to grow, the need may arise and Aligned Automation reserves the right to revise, supplement, or rescind any policies or portion of the HR Manual from time to time as it deems appropriate, in its sole and absolute discretion.

Welcome Message

Welcome! Thank you for joining Aligned Automation Services Private Limited. We believe you have a great contribution to make to Aligned Automation and that you will find your employment at Aligned Automation a rewarding experience. We look forward to the opportunity of working together to create a more successful Company. We also want you to feel that your employment with Aligned Automation will be one that is mutually beneficial and gratifying.

We hope that you will find satisfaction in your endeavour with Aligned Automation and take pride in your work and your values. We hope that you will represent our company well.

Nitin Ahuja - Chief Executive Officer

About Aligned Automation

Aligned Automation works towards planning, designing, implementing and digital transformation solutions by utilizing best of breed platforms and applications. With highly dedicated team and expertise in the field of analytics, supply chain, automation, data technology strategy implementation and management, we help to identify the best practices that leverages intelligent automation to enhance business control and improved performance.

Leadership Team



Nitin Ahuja
Chief Executive Officer



Rajnesh Kumar
Chief Operating Officer

What We Do

Managed Services

Digital BPO

Provide a digitally enabled outsourced workforce that will own and drive metrics & KPIs and deliver a world class customer experience

Visibility & Reporting

Provide visibility & control over the business across internal & external entities

Operational Analytics

Provide actionable intelligence to identify & mitigate risk proactively through predictive analytics

COE

Operations Transformation

Evaluate & transform the business processes for higher efficiency

Process Optimization

Impact key metrics via process redesign and optimization

Data & Technology Strategy

Evaluate existing systems & data sources and recommend a data strategy to align with business outcomes and goals

System Integration

System Implementation

Configure, test, deploy, maintain & support world-class software systems

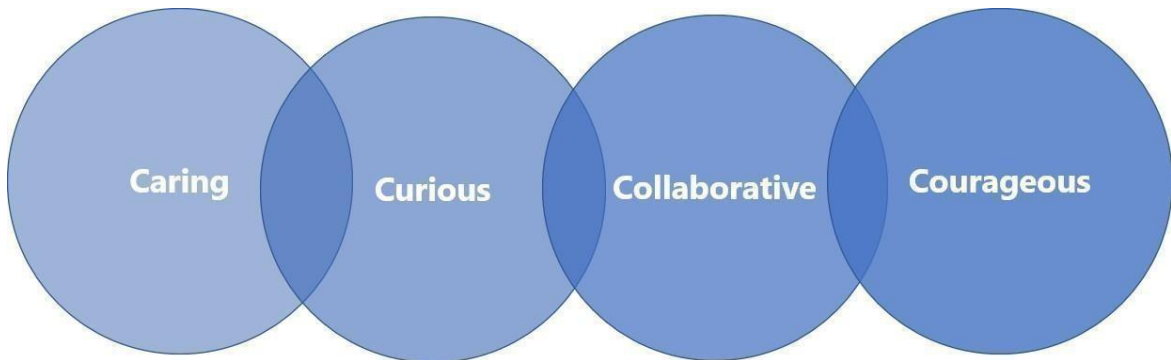
Application Development

Design, architect, develop and configure custom applications

Data Management Services

Execute to data strategy through data integration, transformation and establishing a curated data repository

Our Culture Values



- We are caring - We care for our customers, our teammates, ourselves. We behave with Kind Optimism.
- We are curious - We never stop asking. We never stop learning.
- We are collaborative - We are Better Together. Collectively we solve problems. We win together.
- We are courageous - We take on challenges. We deliver purposeful innovation.

EMPLOYMENT

Aligned Automation values the talent and abilities of our employees and seeks to foster an open, cooperative, and dynamic environment in which employees and the company alike can thrive. The company provides an 'Open Door Policy' in which employees are encouraged to take problems to the next level of management if they are unable to resolve a situation with their direct manager.

Equal Employment Opportunity

The company provides equal employment opportunities to all employees and applicants without regard to race, colour, religion, gender, sexual orientation, national origin, age, disability. In addition, the company complies with applicable state and local laws governing non-discrimination in employment in every location in which the company has facilities. This policy applies to all terms and conditions of employment.

Diversity in Recruitment and Career Progression

Aligned Automation is committed to building a diverse and inclusive workforce. We believe that diversity of thought and experience is essential to our success. We encourage recruitment managers to seek candidates from diverse backgrounds, utilize inclusive job advertisements, and provide necessary accommodations for candidates with disabilities.

We also encourage supervisors to consider diversity in the promotion process by ensuring that all employees are aware of the criteria and expectations for promotion. We provide mentoring and career development opportunities to facilitate professional growth for all employees.

Code of Conduct and Business Ethics

Employees are expected to accept certain responsibilities, follow acceptable business principles in matters of conduct, and always exhibit a high degree of integrity. This not only involves sincere respect for the rights and feelings of others, but also demands that employees refrain from any behavior that might be harmful to themselves, co-workers, the company, or that might be viewed unfavorably by current or potential customers or by the public at large. Aligned Automation will comply with all applicable laws and regulations and expects its employees to conduct business in accordance with the same. Employees should refrain from any illegal, dishonest, or unethical conduct.

Employee conduct reflects on the company. Employees are, consequently, always encouraged to observe the highest standards of professionalism.

Dealing with Customer

The company strives to consistently provide customers with a product and service that is of exceptional quality and value. To realize our commitment to excellent customer service, we expect the following from each of our employees -

- Provide courteous service in a prompt and efficient manner.
- Establish and maintain positive relationships with customers by gaining their trust and respect through professional, honest interaction.
- Handle complaints quickly and professionally. If an employee is unable to resolve a complaint to customer's satisfaction, he should review the situation with his manager.
- Communicate with customers in a professional manner whether in person, over the phone, or via e-mail.
- Always remember that employee is the face of the company to our customers and our reputation and the customer's perception of the company is attributed to each employee

Conflict of Interest

Employees have an obligation to conduct business within guidelines that prohibit actual or potential conflicts of interest.

An actual or potential conflict of interest occurs when an employee can influence a decision that may result in a personal gain for that employee or for a relative because of Aligned Automation business dealings. If employees have any influence on transactions involving purchases, contracts, or leases, it is imperative that they disclose it to Aligned Automation HR as soon as possible the existence of any actual or potential conflict of interest so that safeguards can be established to protect all parties.

Personal gain may result not only in cases where an employee or relative has a significant ownership in a firm with which Aligned Automation does business, but also when an employee or relative receives any kickback, bribe, substantial gift, or special consideration as a result of any transaction or business dealings involving Aligned Automation.

Your position with the company calls for your whole-time employment and you will devote yourself exclusively to the business of the company. You will not take up any other work for remuneration (part time or otherwise) or work in an advisory capacity or be interested directly or indirectly in any other trade of business, without the written permission from the company.

The employees of the Company during the period of employment by the Company shall not engage in any employment or work for gain or undertake any business activity other than for the Company. The employee any time during employment and post-employment for 24 months shall not directly or indirectly undertake any activity and/or engage any activity and/or be associated with any entity or person which.

Confidentiality

The position held by you would be of a strictly confidential nature. You will not during your employment with the company or at any time thereafter, divulge or make known any information in any way whatsoever relating to the company or its business or of its customer and/or any other information, secret processes of data and material, which may come to your knowledge during the course of your employment. You will always maintain strict secrecy regarding any technical information, or any other information gained or acquired or imparted to you in the course of your employment.

You shall not communicate to any public papers, journals, pamphlets or leaflets, or cause to be disclosed at any time, any information, data or documents, official or otherwise, relating to the company except with prior written consent of an authorized officer of the company.

All information that comes to your knowledge by reasons of your employment with the company is deemed to be confidential and any breach thereof, shall be deemed to be a violation of company rules and necessary action will be taken thereof.

The company expects you to respect all matters, which are Intellectual Property Rights of your past employer, and strongly discourages you to bring in to the company; manuals, documents, papers, memos, and files etc., which are classified. The company is recruiting you for your inherent experience, skills, knowledge, and attitude that you have exhibited at the time of the selection process.

On the date of joining you will also be obligated to sign a Non-Disclosure Agreement which will be part of your employment contract.

Child and Forced Labor

Aligned Automation has a zero-tolerance policy for child and forced labor in our operations and supply chain. We expect all employees, suppliers, and business partners to uphold this policy, and we will take immediate action to address any violations. We encourage anyone with concerns about child or forced labor to report them, and we are committed to promoting fair labor practices and protecting the rights of all workers.

Modern Slavery

We are committed to eradicating modern slavery from our operations and supply chain, and we have a zero-tolerance policy in place. We encourage all employees to report any incidents or concerns related to modern slavery and we will take immediate action to address any violations.

WORK ENVIRONMENT

Inclusive Work Environment

At Aligned Automation, we value a positive and inclusive work environment where all employees feel respected, supported, and valued. We expect each member to contribute to this environment by:

- Being respectful of everyone's differences and backgrounds.
- Communicating openly and honestly with each other.
- Being mindful of your language and avoid using offensive or discriminatory language.
- Collaborating effectively and working together as a team.
- Being open to feedback and constructive criticism.
- Supporting each other's professional development and growth.
- Creating a safe and inclusive space where everyone feels comfortable sharing their ideas and feedback.

We believe that a positive and inclusive work environment is essential to our success. When all team members feel respected and valued, they are more likely to be engaged, productive, and creative. We are committed to creating a workplace where everyone can thrive.

Safety

Each employee is expected to obey safety rules and to exercise caution in all work activities. Employees must immediately report any unsafe condition to the appropriate manager. Employees who violate safety standards, who cause hazardous or dangerous situations, or who fail to report or, where appropriate, remedy such situations may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment. In the case of accidents that result in injury, regardless of how insignificant the injury may appear, employees should immediately notify the Human Resources Function or manager.

Open Communication

We believe that by having open communication, information about the company is communicated quickly and accurately. Input from everyone in the organization is considered valuable.

For good teamwork, regular communication between team members must be firmly established; everyone must be aware of the team objectives and be clear of their contribution towards Aligned Automation. Regular team/Project meetings/telephone calls should be held to ensure good communication so that objectives can be clearly understood and performance measured.

Personal Appearance

Dress, grooming, and personal cleanliness standards contribute to the morale of all employees and affect the business image that Aligned Automation presents to the community.

During business hours or when representing Aligned Automation, you are expected to present a clean and neat appearance. You should dress and groom yourself according to the requirements of your position and accepted social standards.

Smoking, Drinking and Drugs

It is our desire that every employee of Aligned Automation can work in a smoke free environment. Aligned Automation has established a non-smoking policy. Smoking is not permitted in workplace. Only smoking zones defined in pantry can be used for this purpose. Employees will not be allowed to report in the premises under the influence of alcohol or narcotic drugs.

Flexible Work Timing

The company provides Flexi working time. Employees can choose to shift their everyday schedule by starting the day later or leaving earlier so that they can manage their personal work and office.

Work from Home

It helps employee to work from their house, apartment, or from comfort places.

ONBOARDING

Diversity Recruitment and Career Progression:

Aligned Automation is committed to building a diverse and inclusive workforce. We believe that diversity of thought and experience is essential to our success. We encourage recruitment managers to seek candidates from diverse backgrounds, utilize inclusive job advertisements, and provide necessary accommodations for candidates with disabilities.

We also encourage supervisors to consider diversity in the promotion process by ensuring that all employees are aware of the criteria and expectations for promotion. We provide mentoring and career development opportunities to facilitate professional growth for all employees.

Process

- New hire's joining formalities, documentation and related paperwork shall be completed by HR on the day of their joining
- Asset allocation to the new hire shall be completed by Admin and IT team
- New hire will undergo induction and orientation session scheduled by HR in order to get familiar with Aligned Automation policies, work culture and nature of business in detail. These sessions are mandatory to attend for all new hires
- HR will facilitate new hire's introduction meeting with the respective account manager and team

Relocation and Initial Accommodation

Relocation:

If you are relocating to Pune/Bengaluru, company will assist you in bearing the relocation cost which will include your travel ticket and cost of shifting luggage. The upper limit for such relocation will be INR 30,000 (Thirty thousand only) or actual whichever is less. Relocation expenses can be reimbursed only if the relocation is done within 3 months from the date of joining.

You will be required to provide supporting documents related to all the expenses incurred prior to obtaining the relocation reimbursements.

Accommodation:

Company will arrange for your accommodation for a week in a Hotel/Service apartment. If you are not able to find a place for yourself during that time and want to extend the stay at the hotel, company will bear 50% of the hotel stay rent for 1 more week of your stay. Thereafter, the company will not bear any cost in this regard.

Scope:

- An employee will be eligible to have his/her relocation expenses reimbursed after relocating to a new job location that is in a new City/Town than his/her former residence was to his former job location
- Relocated employees shall submit, in reasonable detail, vouchers for all expenses incurred to the HR for approval and reimbursement
- All relocation related expenses should be filed separately from other types of reimbursable business expenses and should be clearly marked "Relocation Expenses"
- It is not the intent of the Company to provide an upgrade in housing (e.g., move from rental to ownership of residence, purchase of home with substantial adjoining land, purchase of multiple unit residence, etc.) for relocating employees
- Employees to be relocated should be made fully aware of the contents of this policy. Any questionable expenses should be resolved with the HR Team before the expense is incurred. Because relocation involves many aspects, any exceptions to this policy requires the prior approval of the Management

Guidelines:

In case you leave the services of the Company within six months of joining and has been paid relocation expenses, the same shall be recovered in full as a part of the full and final settlement.

If you leave the services of the Company after six months but within one year of joining and has been paid relocation expenses, 50% of the amount paid as relocation expenses shall be recovered as part of full and final settlement

EMPLOYMENT STATUS AND RECORDS

Probationer

The first three (3) months of your employment shall be considered a probationary period. This period can be extended for a further period of maximum three (3) months at company's discretion, and you would not be deemed to be confirmed unless a confirmation letter is given to you in writing. During probation, or its extension, either party may terminate this relationship giving one months' notice. Further the Company may at its discretion relieve you from such date as it may deem fit even before the expiry of the notice period with or without compensating for the un-expired period and is not bound to give any reason thereof. During the probation period you will not be granted any paid leave.

Confirmed Employee

Once the company will find the employees' performance to be satisfactory and feels the employee is suitable for the job, company will confirm the job of the employee and will be given a confirmation letter in writing. Only then, will the employee be eligible for benefits of confirmed employee.

Access to Personnel Files

Aligned Automation maintains a personnel file on each employee. The personnel file includes such information as the employee's job application, résumé, records of training, documentation of performance appraisals and salary increases, and other employment records.

Personnel files are the property of Aligned Automation and access to the information they contain is restricted. Generally, only managers and management personnel of Aligned Automation who have a legitimate reason to review information in a file can do so.

Personal Data Changes

It is the responsibility of each employee to promptly notify Aligned Automation of any changes in personal data. Personal mailing addresses, telephone numbers, number and names of dependents, individuals to be contacted in the event of an emergency, educational accomplishments, and other such status reports should be accurate and current at all times. If any personal data has changed, notify the HR as soon as possible with relevant documents.

IT PRACTICES

Data Privacy

Aligned Automation is dedicated to protecting the privacy and security of the personal and sensitive data we handle. We comply with all relevant data protection laws and regulations to ensure that your data is confidential, accurate, and accessible. Employees are expected to handle data with the utmost care, in accordance with our data privacy policies and procedures. Any breaches or concerns related to data privacy should be reported immediately. We value your trust, and we are committed to maintaining the highest standards of data privacy and security.

Access Card / ID card

Company provides employee with an access card by which various locations in the premises are accessible to him/her. This is not chargeable. However, in case an employee loses / damages the access card, new card will be charged at INR 250 (Rupees Two Hundred and Fifty).

If an employee loses or damages his/her photo identity card, the new card will be charged at INR 100 (Rupees One Hundred). If an employee loses or misplaces either his/her access card or identity card, it is his/her responsibility to inform the admin team immediately.

Company Owned Communication Systems

Any device or computer including, but not limited to, desk phones, smartphones, fax, tablets, laptops, desktop computers, iPads, internet, corporate intranet, voicemail, computer terminals, modems and systems software that the company provides for your use, should only be used for company business. Employees are expected to adhere to their proper use and must comply with company policies and procedures regarding its use. Keep in mind that the company owns the devices and the information in these devices. If you leave the company for any reason, the company will require that you return the equipment on your last day of work. You may use personal electronic devices that are not connected to the Company network to access any appropriate internet site during breaks and lunch.

Internet Code of Conduct

Internet usage on company-owned devices that are connected to the company's network is authorized to conduct company business only. Internet use brings the possibility of breaches of the security of confidential company information.

Internet use also creates the possibility of contamination to our system via viruses or spyware. Spyware allows unauthorized people, outside of the company, potential access to company passwords and other confidential information. Removing such programs from the company network requires IT staff to invest time and attention hence employee should limit internet use.

Additionally, under no circumstances may company owned computers or other electronic equipment, including devices owned by the employee, be used during official time at work to obtain, view, or reach any pornographic, or otherwise immoral, unethical, or non-business-related internet sites. Doing so can lead to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

Email Usage at the Company

The email system is reserved for business purposes only. Employees should refrain from sending or receiving personal email at the workplace. The e-mail system is the property of Aligned Automation. Occasional use of the e-mail system for personal messages is permitted, within reasonable limits. Aligned Automation will not guarantee the privacy of the e-mail system except to the extent required by law.

Software Access Procedure

Software needed, in addition to the Microsoft Office suite of products, must be authorized by your manager and downloaded by the IT department. If you need access to software or websites, not currently on the company network, get approval from your manager and consult with IT department to explain what returns you expect to receive from the product. All reasonable requests that are considered a network risk will not be considered.

Social Media

We strongly encourage you to limit the use of social media to work-related content and outreach during work hours. Additionally, you are prohibited from sharing any confidential or protected information that belongs to or is about the company on social media. The company's reputation and brand should be protected by all employees. The lives and actions of your co-workers should never be shared online. In social media participation from work devices or during working hours, social media content that discriminates against any protected classification including age, race, colour, religion, gender, sexual preference, national origin, disability, or genetic information is prohibited.

Communications

Each employee is responsible for the content of all text, audio or images that they place or send over the internet. Fraudulent, harassing, or obscene messages are prohibited. All messages communicated on the internet should have employees name attached. No messages will be transmitted under an assumed name. Users may not attempt to obscure the origin of any message. Information published on the internet should not violate or infringe upon the rights of others. No abusive, profane, or offensive language may be transmitted through the system. Employees who wish to express personal opinions on the internet should use non-company internet systems.

EMPLOYEE COMPENSATION AND BENEFITS

Compensation

Compensation and benefits in Aligned Automation are competitive which allows us to attract and motivate a well-qualified, diverse workforce. They have been structured in a tax effective manner with the overriding philosophy being Income Tax compliance as opposed to Income Tax avoidance. Employees whose positions entitle them to minimum wage are paid as per Minimum Wages Act prevailing at the time.

Pay Cycle & Payday

Pay cycle will be from 1st to last day of the month which will be paid on the last working day of the month.

If an employee joins after 15th of any month, his salary for the number of days worked in the joining month will be processed with next month's salary.

Mode of Salary Payment

Salary will be credited to your corporate account. All employees are expected to maintain a corporate bank account as salary is paid by bank transfers. The bank account opening process will be completed along with the joining process.

Compensation Structure

Company strongly believes in strictly conforming to the laws and the salary structure will be in accordance with the tax laws prevailing in India. The compensation structure is as per the terms of appointment of individual employees.

Administrative Pay Corrections

Aligned Automation takes all reasonable steps to ensure that employees receive the correct amount of pay in each pay-check and that employees are paid promptly on the scheduled payday. In the unlikely event that there is an error in the amount of pay, the employee should promptly bring the discrepancy to the attention of the HR so that corrections can be made as quickly as possible.

Pay Deductions/Setoffs & Taxation of Salary

The law requires that Aligned Automation make certain deductions from every employee's compensation. All salary income that is earned from 1st April to 31st March each financial year is taxable as per the Income Tax Act, including the fringe benefit tax provisions and other applicable laws prevailing at that time.

As per the new Finance Act, Government has provided an option to file the Income Tax Return as per Old Regime (where all deductions and Exemptions are allowed) or by New regime (where tax need to be paid on Gross Salary as per the income slab).

We at Aligned Automation as an Organization has decided to go with the tax new regime where under this regime there is no need to declare the investments at the beginning of financial year. However, the employee can choose their option at the time of filing their Income Tax Return end of the year and claim any exemptions if applicable.

Hence, please note, TDS will be deducted as per New Regime.

Salary Advance

In case of salary advance requirement, an employee may avail from the company only in the event of a medical emergency or for marriage (Employees) purposes. Only confirmed employees are eligible. Advance salary can be availed no more than once in a financial year. To apply for an advance salary, the employee must complete the Advance Salary Form and obtain the necessary approvals. All approvals are subject to management's

discretion. An employee may avail of an advance salary of up to two times their monthly basic salary. The disbursement of the advance amount will be made within 15 days from the date the requisition is submitted by the employee.

BENEFITS

Eligible employees at Aligned Automation are provided a wide range of benefits as below.

Health Insurance

Aligned Automation will provide all employees with 'Medical' and 'Personal Accident' insurance coverage. Premium of the same will be borne by the company. Besides, Aligned Automation will also make available voluntary option of Group Health Insurance Program for dependent parents i.e. for employee's father/mother/father-in-law/mother-in-law where employees can enjoy pre negotiated group corporate benefits. Subsidized premium of the same will be borne by the employees. Insurance premium is calculated on pro rata basis. Insurance benefits will automatically be terminated on the date of leaving.

- **Group Health Insurance Policy** with the coverage of 7 LPA (Self+ Spouse+ Children) (premium borne by employer)
- **Group Personal Accident Policy** with the coverage of 10 LPA (premium borne by employer)
- **Parents Health Insurance Policy** with coverage of 3 LPA (Optional and premium borne by employee)

Each employee is required to familiarize oneself with the details of insurance policy that are on Zoho.

Other corporate tie-ups:

Practo- Corporate Health Plan: Employees can register themselves & dependents on this app and can avail multiple health benefits.

Creche facility: Company has tied up with creche facility (Eurokids) which is within 2km of the company premises. This is to ensure and provide a safe, hygienic, and secured environment for the children of company's privileged and designated employees. (Please refer corporate rates offered by the creche facility on Nexus & Zoho)

Restaurants: Company has tied up with multiple restaurants nearby the company premises wherein employees can go and avail corporate discounts on the food & services. (Please refer corporate tie up list on Nexus)

Subsidized meals: Employees can enjoy meals (Breakfast, Lunch, Snacks, Dinner) at the company premises on the subsidized rate by paying employee contribution to the vendor through google/Paytm app. (Please connect with the admin team for the rates)

Holidays

All employees are eligible to receive company paid holidays per calendar year 11 holiday in India and 9 holidays in US. The approved holiday list will be published to all employees in the last week each year for the succeeding year. Employees who are required to work on a holiday will be compensated with a holiday on some other day at manager's discretion considering work priorities.

Provident Fund

The Employee Provident Fund is a retirement saving scheme available to all the salaried employees. The employee contributes 12% of basic wages and employer contribute 13% of the basic wages to the provident fund (PF) account. Thus, the total contribution to the PF is 25% per month.

The employee contribution to the EPF can be claimed for the deductions under section 80 C of the Income Tax Act.

Gratuity

A permanent employee shall be eligible for Gratuity as per the Gratuity Act, 1972. Employee will be entitled for gratuity payment only if he has completed five years of continuous service at the time of leaving company.

Gratuity is paid on occurrence of any of the following: retirement, resignation, permanent disablement or death. In case of sudden death in service or permanent disablement, the gratuity period will be counted till the time of retirement.

A part or the whole of Gratuity may be forfeited in case of an employee's dismissal from service due to any wilful damage/destruction of company property or due to any act of moral turpitude.

ESIC

ESI scheme is a type of social security scheme for employees. The employees registered under the scheme are entitled to medical treatment for themselves and their dependents, unemployment cash benefit in certain contingencies, outpatient medical facilities, inpatient care in ESI hospitals and maternity benefit in case of women employees. In case of employment-related disablement or death, there is provision for a disablement benefit and a family pension respectively. For all employees earning ₹21,000 or less per month as wages, the employer contributes 3.25 percent and employee contributes 0.75 percent, total share 4% percent.

Referral Bonus

Our Employee Referral Policy explains important aspects of our employee referral procedures. We place great importance on referrals because we trust our employees know what is best for our company. We want to make this process as smooth as possible for our employees and those who they refer.

- Employee may refer individuals who fit the specifications given in job descriptions for vacant positions which HR posts from time to time. In case the profile is already available in the data bank the referral process will be terminated at this stage
- The employee's role will be limited to the submission of the profile of the candidate. After this the regular process of short listing and interviews will be applied to the referrals also
- The employee making the referral will not in any way be involved with the interview or salary fixation of the candidate
- Selection of the referral would be made only after going through the selection process, as per recruitment policy / procedures
- There should be no specific canvassing in case of a referred candidate by both the employee who referred him and the HR

Guidelines:

- The referred candidate must be a full-time employee for the referral to be eligible for the bonus.
- In case of Duplicate referrals only the first referral will be eligible for the bonus
- The referring employee must be employed on the day their referred achieves 90 days of employment to be eligible for referral amount
- The referral amount will be paid as per below parameters:

Candidate experience	Employee reward
0-2 Years	NIL
2-6 Years	15,000/-
6-12 Years	30,000/-
12+ Years	45,000/-

- The referral amount will be paid post completion of 90 days of the referred employee provided the referral is not serving the notice period.

- The amount will be credited to the referral along with the subsequent month salary.
- *Note-Referral bonus will be taxable.
- There is no limit to the number of referrals an employee can make, or the number of monetary referral awards received.
- Submittal of a candidate does not guarantee they will be contacted or interviewed.
- The Company is not obligated to disclose to referrer reasons for not hiring or circumstances for dismissal of any referral.

Any employee referring a candidate will not be directly involved in the interview process against the referral.

Leave

Leave is granted to employees with the good intention of providing rest, recuperation of health and for fulfilling social & personal obligations. This provides for a healthy and efficient workforce for the company. This policy is applicable to all the permanent employees.

Leave calendar and applicability:

Leave calendar is from 1st April to 31st March.

Sanctioning of leave is based on exigencies of business or seriousness of the case.

The CL's and PL's will be credited in the end of every month starting from the month of April. Eligible leaves start getting credited to the employees leave account on the 1st of April every year. Types of leaves given under the policy are:

1. **Casual Leave (CL)- 12**
2. **Privileged Leave (PL)- 21**
3. **Maternity Leave (ML) -As per Act**
4. **Paternity Leave (PL)- 5**
5. **Loss of Pay (LOP)**
6. **Comp Off**

- Leave policy is applicable for all permanent employees of the company
- Employees who are appointed during the year shall be entitled to the above leaves on pro-rata basis
- Employees whose date of joining service falls between 1st to the 15th of a month are entitled to get the leave credit for that month
- Employees whose date of joining service falls between 16th to the end of the month are not entitled for the leave credit for that month
- If an employee is relieved on any day between 1st to 15th of a month, then he / she is not entitled for leaves due for that month
- If an employee happens to leave on any day between 16th to the end of the month then he / she is entitled for leaves due for that month
- During Probation, the employee cannot avail the PLs, however they are entitled to 1 CL per month.
- The accrued PLs during probation will be credited to the employee's leave balance post confirmation
- Any leave taken during notice period will be considered as Loss of pay

Casual(sick) leave (CL)

- 12 days of Casual (+Sick) Leave in a calendar year
- Employees are entitled to avail up to 3 consecutive days of Casual Leave (CL) at a maximum. If an employee wishes to take more than 3 days of CL in one instance, they must apply for Privileged Leave (PL). If an employee has no remaining Privileged Leave (PL), they must apply for Loss of Pay.
- Intervening National / Festival / Declared holidays will NOT be counted as part of the leave
- Any unutilized CL Balance as on 31st March will lapse

- When leave is taken without prior approval (under certain unavoidable circumstances), the absence should be notified to the respective account manager on the same day via E- mail/Text/Call
- CL will automatically lapse at the time of leaving. CL cannot be adjusted against notice period and are not eligible for encashment

Privileged (earned) leave (PL)

- 21 days of Privileged Leave in a calendar year (April to March).
- Employees will be entitled to 1.75 PL's per month
- Employees are required to avail the mandatory 10 Privilege Leaves (PL) each year; if not taken, these 10 mandatory PL will lapse at the end of financial year.
- During Probation, the employee cannot avail the PLs, however the accrued PLs during
- Probation will be credited to the employee's leave balance post confirmation PL can be availed only on prior approval
- Intervening National / declared / festival / weekly off days will NOT BE counted as part of the
- Any un-availed Earned/Privileged leave at the end of the year will be carried forward up to a maximum of 45 (forty-five) days and will not be encashed
- In case PL's are available at the time of resignation then the same can be adjusted with notice
- only at manager's discretion
- If an employee has been relieved before completing his notice period then the rest of the period will be balanced against the PL balance available in their account
- If PL's are not adjusted with notice period then the same will be eligible for encashment. The encashment will be on the basis of gross salary which will be settled with full and final settlement
- There is no encashment of PL's during the continuation of service

Maternity leave (ML)

- To qualify for maternity leave benefits an employee must have completed at least six months of service with the company by the qualifying week (i.e. week before the expected week of confinement)
- All employees are statutorily entitled to ML of 26 weeks twice (not more than 8 weeks before the confinement and rest thereafter) either during pregnancy or in case of non-wilful medical termination of pregnancy
- 26 weeks will be calculated including weekends and holidays falling in ML duration
- ML will automatically start (if it has not already begun) on the day baby is born
- Full monthly salary as per most recent agreement with employee will be paid to her during ML
- All such leave period must be intimated at least 30 days prior to availing this leave
- Employee along with managers' help should create a backup/make alternate arrangements/ transferring tasks/assignments/responsibilities to cover her absence
- An employee on ML can club her unused privilege leave and casual leave along with her maternity leave
- ML cannot be compensated in case employee is leaving in said duration
- Nursing mother shall be allowed 4 visits a day to the crèche which shall include the interval for rest allowed to her
- Before applying for ML, HR should be informed so that ML can be credited to your account in HR records

Miscarriage

In case of miscarriage and medical termination of pregnancy, employee shall, on production of appropriate medical proof, be entitled to leave with salary at the rate of maternity benefit for a period of six weeks immediately following the day of her miscarriage.

Adoption or Surrogacy

In case of adoption of a child below the age of three months or a commissioning mother both shall be entitled to maternity benefit for a period of twelve weeks from the date the child is handed over to the adopting

mother or the commissioning mother, as the case may be.

Paternity leave (PATL)

All employees are statutorily entitled to PATL of 5 days within a month from when the baby is born.

Loss of pay (LOP):

LOP can be applied by an employee when no other leave is available.

A maximum of 3 months of LOP can be availed on the approval of the management. (Exceptional cases like ML/SL, etc.)

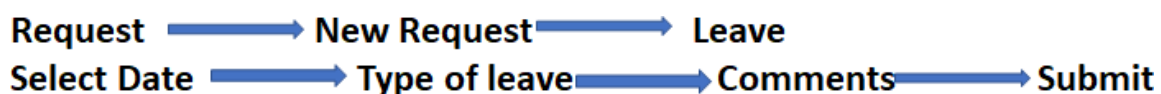
- If the employee fails to report to duty on the specified date after the sanctioned LOP, it is deemed that the employee has abandoned his service with the company on his own accord
- LOP can be implicated on disciplinary grounds about attendance by the management regardless to the availability of the other types of leave
- In case of no CL balance during probation, any additional leave taken will be considered as LOP
- Any leave taken without prior approval of the reporting manager will be considered as LOP, irrespective of CL and PL balance

Compensatory off (COMPOFF):

- If an employee is required to work on any important assignment on a National / Festival / Declared / weekly off day, he/she is eligible for Compensatory off on any other working day.
- Official approval is required from the Account Manager / Management to work on such National/ Festival / Declared / weekly off days. No compensatory offs will be entertained when worked on these days without proper approval
- The compensatory off must be availed within a period of 45 days from the date worked, if not availed within the stipulated period it would get lapsed.
- The un-utilized comp off's will get lapsed on 31st March

Procedure for applying leave

All leaves are to be applied on the Zoho Portal. Given below is the stepwise process for applying the leave on the Zoho portal: -



*The leaves approved or rejected by the manager will be notified to the employee through an auto generation email from Zoho

Cancellation of leave

The Reporting manager can also cancel the once sanctioned leave on situational / need basis. If an employee proceeds to avail the cancelled leave then those days will be treated as absence from work and the rules pertaining to absence from duty will be applied.

Extension of leave

As it is necessary to get prior approval for leave so it is also for extension of leave. The employee must apply to his/her account manager for extension of leave well in advance and get it sanctioned to avail them. In case an employee overstay, the unsanctioned leave availed will be treated as absence from work.

Absence from work

When an employee takes off from duty without prior leave approval or proper intimation under certain unavoidable circumstances, then those day/days will be treated as absence from duty.

- The days of absence will be treated under Loss of Pay
- The employee must report to his / her account manager on re-joining duty from absence and provide valid reasons for absence in writing before taking up work again
- If an employee is absent from duty continuously for more than 7 days (including any National / Festival / Declared / weekly off days which may fall in-between), an official correspondence from the HR department will be sent to him asking to report to duty and to provide explanation for his/her absence
- Based on the enquiry any action deemed fit will/would be taken by the management
- If there were no response from the employee within the stipulated time mentioned in official correspondence, it would be assumed that the employee has withdrawn his/her service from the company on his/her own accord and recorded accordingly

PERFORMANCE REVIEW SYSTEM

Outline and Scope

At Aligned Automation we recognize that the performance of its employees, the skills, knowledge and experience that they bring to their work are essential ingredients to ensure company accomplishes its strategic business objectives. Aligned Automation support all employees and provide opportunities to develop knowledge and competence associated with the work that they do now, and in preparation for the future.

To enhance the contribution made by each employee in achieving business goals, and to build a supportive and cooperative working environment, Aligned Automation has a system of performance review. It also provides dedicated time to reflect on past work as well as plan ahead for the future. This is designed to enhance the contribution made by each employee in achieving business goals, and to build a supportive and cooperative working environment. It also provides dedicated time to reflect on past work as well as plan ahead for the future

Eligibility

It applies to all full-time employees who join us latest by 30th September of each financial year. The annual period of performance of an employee covered by this policy starts on April 1st of the previous year through March 31st of the current year.

Duration & Frequency

Performance evaluation is carried out annually and review cycle is from April to March each year.

Performance Management Cycle

SMART goals are established at the beginning of the financial year or at the time of joining.

S	Specific	Action (Verb)	Output/Results (noun)
M	Measurable	Quantity (How many)	
A	Achievable	Can this really be achieved in the right quantity, quality, time, and cost	Quality (Descriptor)
		Cost (how many)	Timeliness (how often)
R	Relevant	Does this link to our strategy?	
T	Time Bound	Time (by when)	

Employee performance review and training need identification will be conducted as per review cycle.

Performance Evaluation Responsibilities:

Employee receiving the evaluation is responsible for

- Setting annual goals in collaboration with their manager and creating a plan to achieve the same
- Providing a self-assessment that summarizes progress towards goals and results

Manager conducting the evaluation is responsible for

- Reviewing employee's goals and providing feedback on the same
- Planning and discussing employee's future goals and charting out a plan to achieve them

Management team is responsible for

- Monitoring performance management activity to ensure that the employee in their area receive regular, consistent, and fair evaluations

Human Resources (HR) is responsible for

- Setting clear procedural guidance, formats, consultation & training in performance management
- Tracking annual performance evaluations and providing reports on completed evaluations to management team

Performance Management & Evaluation Form

- HR will provide performance evaluation templates and guidance through email and Zoho portal. It is expected that Manager will use the same format consistently among employees with similar responsibilities. The employee and the manager should both sign the evaluation to indicate it has been completed
- The form is designed for multiple purposes including -
 1. Performance Agreement - to establish the performance objectives for the upcoming year or period of review
 2. Performance mid - year review/periodic Review - to ensure that objectives are monitored and that feedback on performance is provided
 3. Performance Annual Review - to evaluate the performance for the period under review

- Performance evaluation format templates can be found on Zoho
- Evaluation & Rating Process
- To provide employee and manager a structured opportunity to discuss ideas, goals, and direction for job enhancement, growth, and development. The annual evaluation is most effective through regular one-on-one meetings held through the year to review goals and acknowledge any issues as they arise. These discussions form building blocks for the next review
 - The performance evaluation process should include the following:
 1. Employee completes the self-evaluation of goals in goal sheet form and submits it to his/ her manager by established deadline
 2. Upon careful consideration of employee's performance over the entire rating period and the information provided by the employee, manager completes his assessment form
 3. Manager and employee then discuss employee's performance for the previous year and arrive at mutual understanding about goals and development for the coming year
 4. Manager discusses the evaluation with management

There are five (5) rating categories for each element. These categories are –

Rating	Exceptional	Exceeds	Meets	Needs	Below
Score	Performance	Standards	Standards	Improvement	Standards
	5	4	3	2	1

Performance Improvement Plan

When informal methods of addressing performance concerns have failed, a manager may choose to initiate a formal Performance Improvement Plan (PIP). A Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) is a 30- 90 days process to provide employees with the opportunity to succeed while still holding them accountable for past performance.

The following steps will assist managers in establishing a PIP for an employee

- Document performance issues in PIP templates which are objective, factual & specific.
- Develop an 'Action Plan' in collaboration with employee and sign off the form
- Establish regular follow up meetings
- The employee and manager should conclude if employee has met the objective & establish a schedule for no less than two meetings within the 12 months following the successful completion of a PIP
- If an employee fails to perform as per 'Action Plan' it may lead to termination of services or any other appropriate action

TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT

Introduction

Training and Development is the framework for helping employees to develop their personal and organizational skills, knowledge, and abilities. The focus of all aspects of Human Resource Development is on developing the most superior workforce so that the organization and individual employees can accomplish their work goals in service to customers.

Eligibility

There are many different “pressure points” that suggest that training is necessary for an employee. These pressure points include performance problems, new technology, internal or external customer requests for training, job redesign, and changes in customer preferences, or employees’ lack of basic skills.

Training Process

- Managers post discussion with management will provide list of employees to HR against which the training need to be scheduled
- Accordingly, training will be arranged for selected employees by HR
- Post training completion, feedback of trainer can be recorded by employees
- Performance of employee post training will be accessed by manager and feedback for the same will be shared with HR

BUSINESS TRAVEL

Introduction

Aligned Automation will reimburse employees for reasonable business travel expenses incurred while on assignments away from the normal work location.

Travel Application Process

- All travel requests (destinations, start date, duration, and end date) must be duly approved by concerned team Manager
- Before planning your travel, one must make sure proper visa is available with the traveler if not admin will first make sure the proper visa is arranged. After visa approval, best air fare received from our travel agent are forwarded to concern team for final approval and confirmation
- Upon receipt of duly approved travel request form, admin shall make necessary arrangements for visa processing, ticket booking, forex requirement, airport pick up & drop & overseas insurance
- Travel Insurance
 1. Company shall arrange for travel insurance as applicable through a service provider
 2. Employees are required to collect the entire travel kit along with insurance related documents from admin team two days prior to their departure
 3. Employees are expected to understand, meet, read & familiarize themselves with the terms & conditions, coverage & claim process from finance team before the travel
 4. For all International travels, admin team shall arrange for accommodation at the listed service apartment or hotel based on the availability
 5. Employee can claim reasonable expenses incurred on food, conveyance, telephone charges, etc. with original bills to the Finance Department and with appropriate authorization
 6. International local conveyance needs to be claimed separately at actuals with original bills
- Ticket Booking
 1. Admin Team shall arrange for all travel tickets based on the approvals from the Management
 2. Employees are expected to read & understand the itinerary in detail
 3. Any change in the travel plan (cancellation/ postponement/ change of route etc.) has to be approved by the respective Manager and informed to admin team well in advance
- Paid Holidays/ Leave
 1. Employees shall follow the norms of paid (local/ national) holidays as applicable in the place of assignment
 2. During overseas travel, personal leave shall be granted only for medical emergencies. All such leave shall be applied through Zoho and deducted from the leave balance
 3. Any extension of stay on personal grounds shall be approved by the concerned Manager. The cost of such extension (ticket/stay) shall be borne by the employee. Any expenses shall not be reimbursed by Aligned Automation Services Pvt Ltd for such duration
- If an employee leaves after obtaining a visa, Aligned Automation will be obligated to inform the consulate that the representations made by the company with respect to the employee are not true any longer. This is to ensure that other genuine applicants from the company do not suffer
- Employees who need to travel for official purpose such as to banks, government offices, customer meetings, or other official work, can claim reimbursement as per the company policy
- For domestic official travel, our admin team will make necessary arrangement for ticket reservation, hotel reservation etc.
Employee have to submit travel expense report along with all original bills to finance after resuming office. Travel expense report format is available at Zoho.

EMPLOYEE RELATIONS

Introduction

Since its founding, Aligned Automation has built a culture based on the values of trust, mutual respect, and dialogue. We focus on promoting good management practices, workplace behaviours, positive working environments, and relationships through a variety of services -

- Consulting with individuals and departments to foster a positive and productive work environment
- Providing conflict resolution options including consultation, facilitation, and training, investigating, and resolving work-related complaints
- Advising and training functions on corrective actions and administering Aligned Automation progressive discipline process

Grievance

- A grievance is any dissatisfaction and/or feeling of injustice in connection with an employee member's work and/or employment situation (other than conditions of service and salary range, and other than arising from disciplinary action) which is brought to the attention of the relevant authorities
- No employee may be victimized as a result of his/her raising a grievance
- The intention of the policy is that grievances be resolved at the earliest stage possible and as quickly as possible. The time periods specified below are maximum time periods, to be utilized to the full only where the complexity of the grievance requires the full use thereof
- If employee who initiates this grievance procedure fails to pursue the complaint through the channels provided for, it must be assumed either that employee abides by the resolution reached by that stage, or that the complaint had no substance
- Where an employee's (or group of employee's) grievance arises from allegations of racism, racial discrimination or racial harassment, employee/they must follow the procedure outlined in the Aligned Automation policy on racism and racial harassment. Where a grievance arises out of allegations of sexual harassment, employees must follow the procedure outlined in the policy and procedure on sexual harassment

Procedure for an Individual Grievance

- If any employee wishes to raise a grievance, they must informally approach their manager at which point an attempt must be made to resolve the grievance at this level
- Should the grievance related to the actions of the manager, the employee must in the normal course of events approach the management in an attempt to seek a resolution of the matter
- If the employee so wishes, they may obtain the assistance of HR
- Grievances are often the result of a misunderstanding between two or more parties and misconduct is not necessarily involved. Should, however, a grievance be brought to the attention of management and, after investigation, management is satisfied that there is evidence of misconduct on the part of the employee who is the subject of the grievance, the matter must be handled in terms of the disciplinary procedure. The employee who lodged the grievance may be asked to be a witness at a disciplinary enquiry. The decision to invoke the disciplinary procedure will normally mark the end of the grievance procedure
- If on application either by the grievant or the person grieved against, management is satisfied that the grievance procedure should continue simultaneously or be revived at the conclusion of the disciplinary proceedings

Disciplinary Action

Rules of conduct for Aligned Automation employees are intended to promote the orderly and efficient operation of Aligned Automation, as well as protect the rights of all employees. Violations, therefore, shall be regarded as cause for disciplinary action. Where any misconduct is found by the Management/ HR function,

appropriate disciplinary action shall be taken against the accused. Disciplinary action may include withholding promotion, suspension or even dismissal.

Principles

- Wherever appropriate, informal action will be considered before recourse to the formal procedure
- For formal action, the employee will be informed of the nature of the complaint and an investigation will normally be undertaken before any decision to hold a disciplinary hearing
- An employee may appeal against any formal disciplinary action
- All information will be retained on basis confidential

Documentation

The HR function shall keep complete and accurate documentation of the complaint, its investigation, and the resolution thereof. The incident would be documented in both the complainant's and the accused's files

Disciplinary Dismissals

- Although the company endeavours to provide uninterrupted employment for all employees, there are times when it becomes necessary for the company to terminate employment due to various reasons
- Disciplinary dismissals are considered in connection with dishonesty or misconduct (including breach of company rules)
- Disciplinary dismissals whether for one act or an accumulation, will be without notice or payment in lieu. If an incident has occurred which may warrant dismissal, on its own or when taken with previous offenses, an employee may be suspended from services for a specified period

Misconduct

In order to maintain a fair, consistent and logical discipline in work, the following acts will constitute misconduct on the part of the employee. Any act of omission or commission, either singly or in collaboration with others, which in any manner or form is detrimental to the interests of business or discipline or reputation or prestige of the company, management and the establishment, whether within or outside the premises of the establishment, will be treated as misconduct. Without affecting the generality as stated above, the offences listed in the following paragraphs, constitute punishable misconduct.

Major Misconduct

- Impertinence, insubordination, rude and arrogant behaviour, disobedience, wilful or otherwise, whether alone or with others, of any lawful and reasonable orders of a superior, including the orders which the company may issue under any conditions
- Striking work either singly or with others in contravention of service conditions, or bring out activities detrimental to the interests of the company or any interruptions in work what so ever
- Theft, fraud or misappropriation, or dishonesty in connection with the company's business or property of another person or employee of the company
- Habitual absence without leave, or absence without leave for more than 8 consecutive days or overstaying the sanctioned leave without sufficient cause or absence of duty on refusal of leave by the management
- Causing dislocation of work or inconvenience to other employees due to unauthorized absence of duty
- Dishonestly misappropriating or otherwise converting for their own use any property entrusted to their or under their control as an employee
- Use of indecent behaviour, language with superiors or co-employees or wrongfully interfering with the work of other employees or spreading rumours or any improper act within the company.
- Preaching or inciting violence
- Damage to or loss of any property of the company
- Disclosing any information of the company's process to any unauthorized person
- Gambling or drinking alcohol during working hours within the premises of the company
- Involved in any criminal offence involving moral turpitude punishable under any law in force
- Possession of any lethal weapon in the company premises

- Engaging in any other employment while still in service of the company

Destruction of company's records

Abandonment of Service

- Should an employee remain absent from work without authorization/information for more than 8 consecutive days, it will be presumed that employee is no longer interested in working for the company and has abandoned its services, thereby terminating their contract of service. In such a case, employee shall not be entitled to any compensation other than the statutory ones
- Retirement
Retirement age in Aligned Automation is 60 years. However, the company shall observe Labour Law and based on mutual agreement between employee and management the work period may be extended. In case of extension, employee shall be eligible for a fixed compensation excluding retiral benefits like Provident Fund and Gratuity
- Return of Materials
The employee, upon the termination of their employment with the company for any reason whatsoever, will promptly return all manuals, records, and other materials in his or her possession as well as equipment, if any, given by the Company for use in his/her performance of their duties

Employee Concerns and Suggestions

A concern is a complaint or problem regarding behaviours, social interactions, and leadership issues that occur in the workplace. Concerns should be resolved at the lowest possible level; therefore, employees will follow the leadership chain in presenting their concerns.

Examples of concerns include, but are not limited to -

- Disagreements with or concerns about the application of a policy or process
- Disagreements with or concerns about an employee's corrective action regarding performance or behaviour expectations
- Disagreements with or objections to employee discipline or an investigatory finding of employee wrongdoing

ANTI-HARRASMENT/ ANTI-DISCRIMINATION

Outline and Scope

It is the Aligned Automation stated policy and practice to provide and promote equal employment opportunities for all employees and maintain a work environment in which all individuals are treated with respect and dignity. Harassment, whether verbal, physical or environmental, is unacceptable and will not be tolerated.

Sexual Harassment

Non-Discrimination

Aligned Automation is committed to a workplace free from discrimination of any kind. We believe that diversity and inclusion are essential to our success, and we expect all employees to contribute to a respectful and equitable environment.

Discrimination will not be tolerated in any form, whether in hiring, promotion, compensation, or in daily interactions. If you witness or experience discrimination, harassment, or bias, please report it. We will take your concerns seriously and handle them confidentially.

Sexual harassment includes unwelcome or unwanted conduct of a sexual nature. It is difficult to define all conduct which may constitute sexual harassment in violation of this policy. However, Aligned Automation has provided below examples of behaviour which violate this policy and constitute sexual harassment

- Coerced sexual acts (which may also result in criminal liability)
- Express or implied demands for sexual favours in exchange for favourable reviews, assignments, promotions, continued employment or promises of continued employment
- Unwanted sexual advances or verbal commentary about an individual's body or sexuality
- Staring at, touching, or assaulting an individual's body
- Repeated objectionable sexual jokes, language, epithets, gossip, comments, flirtations, advances, propositions or questions
- Repeatedly asking an employee for a date after the employee has clearly indicated that she is not interested
- Suggestive, insulting, or obscene comments or gestures
- Display of graphic and sexually suggestive objects, pictures, or graffiti in the workplace
- Harassment consistently targeted, even if the content of the verbal abuse is not sexual

The type of behaviour described above is unacceptable not only in the workplace, but also in other work-related settings such as business trips or business-related social events.

Harassment

Harassment is also verbal or physical conduct that degrades, or shows hostility or aversion towards an individual because of an employee race, colour, creed, religion, gender, national origin, marital status, age, disability, sexual orientation or other protected status, or that of persons with whom the individual works.

List of Members of ICC (Internal Complaint Committee) to deal with complaints of Sexual Harassment of working women at workplace in Aligned Automation can be contacted at posh@alignedautomation.com

ICC Members:

1. Prajakta Shah (Chairperson)
2. Seema Yadav
3. Abhinav Mishra
4. Ashwani Tiwary
5. Smita Shetty Kapoor (External Member)
6. Durgesh Jhala
7. Nisha Patil

SEPARATION PROCESS

Types of Separation

Resignation

- Employment services may be terminated by employee, giving notice in writing for sixty days (as mentioned in employee's appointment letter) for confirmed employees and thirty days for any probationer, unless otherwise specified.
- Resignation should be recorded through Zoho only
- On acceptance of the separation notice (resignation), before employee is relieved, employee will hand-over to the company all the company's assets, information and data of the company including, but not limited to, correspondence, specifications, formulae, books, documents, cost data, market data, literature, drawings. Employee shall not use, reproduce, or retain any copies of these items

Termination by Company

- Employment services may be terminated by company, by giving notice in writing for sixty days (as mentioned in employee appointment letter) for confirmed employees and thirty days for any probationer, unless otherwise specified
- Further, the company may at its discretion relieve employee from employment even before the expiry of the notice period with or without compensating for the un-expired period and is not bound to give any reason thereof
- The company reserves the right to terminate employment without notice on grounds of breach of company Terms, misconduct or where employee's performance has been found to be unsatisfactory. Company is not bound to give any reason thereof. The company reserves the right not to accept salary in lieu of notice

Termination in case of redundancy due to business restrictions / Role abolition

Grounds for Redundancy:

- The Company reserves the right, at its sole discretion, to restructure, reorganize, downsize, or streamline its operations in response to business exigencies, technological changes, strategic realignment, mergers, acquisitions, or any other organizational necessity. Where such changes result in abolition, elimination, or unavailability of employee's role or position, employment may be terminated on grounds of redundancy. The Company shall communicate such decisions to employee in writing, clearly stating the organizational basis for the redundancy.

Redundancy Separation Entitlements:

Upon redundancy, and subject to employee's voluntary, amicable, and unconditional resignation in the prescribed form, employee shall be entitled to the following:

- Notice Period in Redundancy: In cases of role abolition or redundancy, notwithstanding the standard notice period, the Company may at its discretion provide 30 days' notice or salary in lieu thereof.
- Pending Wages & Dues: Full and final settlement of all salary, allowances, and reimbursements due and payable up to the effective date of separation. Variable Payout will be governed by the Company's Variable pay Policy.
- Leave Encashment: Encashment of accumulated earned/privilege leave as on the date of separation, computed in accordance with Company policy and applicable Shops & Establishments legislation of the relevant state.
- Gratuity: Payment of gratuity, where eligible, computed at the rate of fifteen (15) days' wages for every completed year of service, subject to a minimum qualifying service period of five (5) years, as

prescribed under the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972.

Termination on Grounds of Poor Performance

- The Company may initiate termination proceedings where an employee fails to meet performance expectations, including consistently not achieving KPIs or targets despite documented feedback, failing to show adequate improvement during a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) (typically 30–90 days), or demonstrating persistent incompetence or inability to perform essential job functions.
- The Company shall not be liable to pay any notice period pay, salary in lieu of notice, or any severance compensation.
- The Company may require the Employee to leave employment immediately without serving the notice period.
- The Employee shall be entitled only to salary and statutory benefits accrued up to the last working day, subject to applicable deductions and company policies.

No Show by Employee (Absconding)

- Absence for a continuous period of 8 days without prior approval of managers (including overstay of leave) will lead to services being terminated without notice
- Company reserves the right to withhold issue of service certificate for “No Show” employees

Retirement

- Employee will automatically retire from the company on attaining the age of 60 years unless employment is terminated prior thereto
- The actual date of retirement shall be the last working day of the calendar month in which employee's sixtieth birthday falls
- Aligned Automation will generally schedule exit interviews at the time of employee's separation. The exit interview will give an opportunity to discuss reason of resignation, suggestions, complaints feedback regarding the company
- Employees will receive their final pay within thirty days after completing their full and final activities on day of leaving

Dues Clearance Process

- Any employee who tenders his/her resignation will be on a notice period as per the agreed employment terms. During that tenure it's the moral responsibility of such employee to hand over his possessions and properties belonging to the company to the assigned person/manager before getting relieved from his/her services
- Manager shall initiate the process and make sure that the backup employee will take over the responsibilities from the outgoing employee by signing his/her 'Dues clearance form' on the last day of working
- On the final day of the employment the outgoing employee shall ensure his/her 'No Dues Clearance Form' with obtained signatures of the concerned reaches the Human Resources Department in order to process his/her Settlement

Asset Submission

- All Aligned Automation employees who are issued equipment like laptop (including power cord) / mobile handset/ data card/ pen drive/ headphone/ speakers, laptop bag etc. shall be returned to the concerned department on their last day of working
- Any damage / loss of the above if found to be because of negligence of the concerned employee, the cost of repair/ replacement shall be recovered from him / her
- Office equipment is for employee's official use & is not transferable

Full & Final Settlement

For processing Full & Final Settlement, following aspects are thoroughly checked, calculated by HR and shared with Finance for settlement.

- Accumulated Leaves as on date for calculating Leave Encashment
- Years of Service more than FIVE YEARS for Gratuity Amount
- Information in 'No Dues Clearance Form' for any Loan Recovery or Salary Payable
- If an employee is leaving before 15th of a particular month then his/her previous month's salary and leaving month's payment for number of days worked will be processed with full and final settlement.
- Employee who's No Dues Clearance is not cleared due to various reasons, their Full & Final Settlement is kept pending and is processed only after clearing all the dues
- In case, an Employee wants to be relieved early before completion of his or her specified notice period, notice pay is recovered based on gross pay from his or her settlement amount. All legal dues as per the normal resignation are given to the Employee

PF and Gratuity Settlement

- For transferring and/or withdrawing the PF amount, employee has the option to fill the respective forms available with HR / Finance and submit the same to finance
- As per the gratuity act, an employee who completes 5 years or more continuous service or either resigns or retires or services terminated or dismissed or discharged are liable to be paid by company
- The payment towards gratuity is payable to all the employees

Notice Pay Recovery

- Employee is required to serve notice period as mentioned in their appointment letter in writing for separation from company. However, the company reserves the right to relieve before the expiry of notice period on payment or recovery on gross salary basis in lieu of notice period, as the case may be
- Amount of notice pay will be settled through Full & Final Settlement
- Notice pay amount would be calculated on the gross salary of an employee

EMPLOYEE DISCLAIMER

The policies and procedures in this HR Manual are designed to serve as guidelines for management action. They are not intended to create any contract or binding agreement between the employer and employee. All policies and procedures outlined in this HR Manual are subject to change or modification at the employer's discretion at any time that particular circumstances warrant.

This HR Manual is provided for informational purposes only. No provision or portion of the HR Manual constitutes an implied or expressed contract, guarantee, or assurance of employment or any right to an employment-related benefit or procedure. Employer reserves the right to change, modify, eliminate, or deviate from any policy or procedure in this HR Manual at any time and to hire, transfer, promote, discipline, terminate, and otherwise manage its employees as it deems appropriate. If you have questions concerning these guidelines, please consult with your manager or HR representative.

EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT FORM

I, _____, hereby acknowledge that I have received a copy of "Aligned Automation Employee HR Manual", which provides guidelines on the policies, procedures, and programs affecting my employment with this organization. I understand Aligned Automation can, at its sole discretion, modify, eliminate, revise, or deviate from the guidelines and information in this HR Manual as circumstances or situations warrant.

I also understand that any changes made by Aligned Automation with respect to its policies, procedures, or programs can supersede, modify, or eliminate any of the policies, procedures, or programs outlined in this HR Manual. I accept responsibility for familiarizing myself with the information in this HR Manual and will seek verification or clarification of its terms or guidance where necessary.

Furthermore, I acknowledge that this HR Manual is neither a contract of employment nor a legal document and nothing in the HR Manual creates an express or implied contract of employment. I understand that I should consult my manager or HR representative if I have any questions that are not answered in this HR Manual.

Sign

Date:

**For Aligned Automation Services Private
Limited**

Date: